

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

TUESDAY, APRIL 28, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVII NO. 98

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 49167.79 ▼ 62.92 0.13% NASDAQ 24887.10 ▲ 0.2% STOXX 600 608.84 ▼ 0.3% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 7/32, yield 4.335% OIL \$96.37 ▲ \$1.97 GOLD \$4,675.40 ▼ \$46.90 EURO \$1.1722 YEN 159.43

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Foreign-based** automakers warned the Trump administration that they are considering pulling their cheapest car models out of the U.S. market if the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement isn't renewed or is watered down. **A1**
- ◆ **Nissan expects** a narrower annual net loss, even as sales continued to decline, citing one-time gains from revised U.S. emissions rules and cost cuts. **B2**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** wavered in early trading and ended mixed, with the S&P 500 and Nasdaq rising 0.1% and 0.2%, respectively, to records and the Dow falling 0.1%. **B11**
- ◆ **OpenAI and Microsoft** reached a deal that allows OpenAI greater freedom within their partnership in a sign of how the companies' competitive needs are shifting. **B1**
- ◆ **Paramount is seeking** FCC approval for Persian Gulf sovereign-wealth funds to take a substantial equity stake in the company as part of its \$81 billion acquisition of Warner Bros. Discovery. **B1**
- ◆ **Shell agreed to buy** ARC Resources for about \$13.6 billion, a deal that gives the purchaser new opportunities to export LNG far from the conflict zones of the Middle East. **B1**
- ◆ **FedEx is preparing** to return its MD-11 cargo jets to service next month, allowing it to cut back on expensive leased planes it enlisted when regulators grounded all MD-11s after another carrier's fatal crash. **B1**
- ◆ **Verizon reported** higher growth in new-customer numbers and lower churn in its first full quarter under Chief Executive Dan Schulman. **B1**

Worldwide

- ◆ **The man accused of** opening fire outside a Washington press gala attended by Trump was charged with three counts, including trying to assassinate the president. **A1, A4**
- ◆ **President Trump called** on Disney's ABC to remove late-night host Jimmy Kimmel over a joke he made about Melania Trump. **A5**
- ◆ **Iran presented** regional mediators with an offer to stop its attacks in the Strait of Hormuz in exchange for an end to the war and a lifting of the U.S. blockade of Iranian ports. **A8**
- ◆ **Tehran is working** to find new ways to store its oil, hoping to avoid a crippling production shutdown as the blockade bottles up its exports and negotiations to end the war remain deadlocked. **A1**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court** grilled Bayer over whether it is liable for failing to warn consumers that its Roundup weedkiller might cause cancer, in proceedings that prolong a legal battle that has occupied the company for years. **A3**
- ◆ **The Defense Department** can temporarily require journalists to be escorted inside the Pentagon, a federal appeals court ruled in a win for the department. **A3**
- ◆ **South Carolina's** measles outbreak is over after the state passed the threshold of 42 days with no new outbreak-related cases, health officials declared. **A6**
- ◆ **Heavy rain slowed** the progress of two southern Georgia wildfires, allowing crews to make some progress in containing the blazes that have destroyed more than 100 homes. **A6**
- ◆ **Pope Leo XIV** prayed in the Vatican with Archbishop of Canterbury Sarah Mullally in a historic meeting with the first female head of the Church of England. **A8**

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In Tense Times, King Aims to Keep Calm, Carry On



TEA PARTY: Britain's King Charles III and Queen Camilla kick off their Washington visit Monday with tea at the White House with the Trumps. The trip, marking 250 years of U.S. independence from Britain, is meant to soothe tense U.S.-U.K. relations. **A7**

Hormuz Standoff Puts Strain On Iran's Oil-Storage Capacity

Tehran is buying time in race to see who blinks first: producers or global consumers

Iran is working to find new ways to store its oil, hoping to avoid a crippling production shutdown as a U.S. naval

By Benoit Faucon,
Georgi Kantchev
and Rebecca Feng

blockade bottles up its exports and negotiations to end the war remain deadlocked. With oil backing up at

home, Iran is reviving derelict sites known as "junk storage," using improvised containers and trying to ship crude by rail to China. The unusual steps are aimed at delaying an infrastructure crisis and blunting Washington's leverage in the standoff over the Strait of Hormuz.

Iran has presented regional mediators with a new offer to stop its attacks in the Strait of Hormuz in exchange for a full end to the war and a lifting of the U.S. blockade of Iranian ports, The Wall Street Journal has reported. It would see discussions about Iran's nuclear program put off for now.

On Monday, President Trump discussed Iran's proposal with his national-security team, White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt said. Leavitt said Trump's red lines on Iran remain clear.

The war between the U.S. and Iran has turned into a race to see who cracks first: Tehran's oil industry or global energy consumers.

Every barrel that can't leave the country through normal export channels must go into a tank, onto a ship, into an improvised storage site—or remain underground.

Iran hopes to avoid the risk of having to turn off the spig-

ots and deepen its revenue losses, said Sanam Vakil, Middle East and North Africa program director at Chatham House, a nonpartisan London think tank. "The shutdown will add pressure and motivate the negotiations."

The first round of talks between the U.S. and Iran ended this month with little progress, then collapsed last week when Iran declined to meet again.

Iran choked off transit through the crucial shipping lanes early in the war with at-

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◆ **Tehran makes a new offer to end the war.....** A8

Cheap Cars At Risk in Trade War, Foreign Brands Say

Foreign-based automakers have warned the Trump administration that they are looking at pulling their cheapest car models out of the U.S. market if the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement isn't renewed or is watered down, according to people familiar with the discussions.

By Sharon Terlep
in Detroit
and Gavin Bade
in Washington

Companies such as Nissan, Hyundai and Toyota are among the few carmakers to offer U.S. consumers new models of small, affordable automobiles after Detroit-based automakers ditched such cars in recent years in favor of SUVs and trucks.

Cars like the Honda Civic and Toyota Corolla are made in the U.S., but rely on parts from all three North American countries. President Trump signed the USMCA in 2020 and provided tariff-free treatment to cars built largely with U.S., Mexican or Canadian parts.

Trump, however, has upended supply chains and cut into foreign automakers' profits with his second-term levies, which charge a 25% tariff on the non-U.S. content of vehicles that previously would have qualified as duty-free under the USMCA deal. Trump has said the levies are needed for national security, and his team has publicly considered ditching the USMCA or split-

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INSIDE



SPORTS

The no-name pitcher who is off to the best start in baseball history. **A16**

BUSINESS & FINANCE

United Airlines abandons its pursuit of rival American Airlines. **B1**

How to Not Get Poisoned At a World Leaders Summit

* * *

Staffers work to ensure Trump and Xi avoid miscues and keep DNA a state secret

BY LINGLING WEI

Xi Jinping had just finished a lunch of herbed-ricotta ravioli at a secluded estate outside San Francisco in 2023 when his security agents sprang into action.

Their mission: ensuring no trace of the Chinese leader's DNA fell into foreign hands. The agents—measuring about 6-foot-3, dressed in identical dark suits—were observed grabbing Xi's utensils and plate and spraying them with an unidentified liquid.

Welcome to the unseen theater of great-power diplomacy, where a meeting of the two

most powerful leaders on earth can hinge on the slightest missed protocol, an unexpected miscue or even a bit of saliva left on a fork. It is a ritual that is at once deeply absurd and deadly serious. The length of a red carpet can say more about the state of the world than official statements.

"These visits are traumatic for those of us who have to organize them," said Rick Waters, a former State Department official who helped organize President Trump's visit to Beijing in 2017.

Ahead of a May 14-15 summit between Trump and Xi in

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Mexico's President Learns Price of Appeasing Trump

A murky CIA operation is the latest headache for Claudia Sheinbaum, whose concessions have fueled political tension

MEXICO CITY—When word reached Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum last week that two Central Intelligence Agency officials had died in a car wreck in northern Mexico while participating in a counterar-

By Santiago Pérez, José de Córdoba
and Michael Amon

cotics operation, she could have chosen to express outrage at an apparently egregious violation of Mexican sovereignty.

Instead, she has struck a muted response. If anyone was to blame, she said publicly, it was the opposition governor of Chihuahua state, whose officers had been working with

the American agents. In the end, she sent a diplomatic note to the U.S. Embassy expressing surprise and requesting information.

Even that display of restraint seemed to irk the powers that be in Washington. Press secretary Karoline Leavitt said that although the U.S. "has seen some cooperation" from Mexico, more needs to be done and that some sympathy for the fallen U.S. officials "would be well worth it."

It was a by-now-familiar pattern in the relationship between the two neighbors. Each time Sheinbaum gives President Trump an inch, he demands a mile. More than a year after both leaders took office, the give

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Now Playing: A Movie Costing \$50 a Ticket

BY BEN FRITZ

One of the best selling points of a night out at the movies has long been how cheap it was for two hours-plus of entertainment. Not so much when it costs \$50 a ticket.

That is how much Regal Cinemas recently charged for opening night seats in the best theaters to see December's "Dune: Part Three."

Eye-popping prices for the most in-demand movies on the best screens are becoming increasingly common as the cinema industry copies the audience-segmentation playbooks of airlines and hotels. Theaters are getting people who love movies and have discretionary income to pay substantially more.

Some 17% of film tickets

sold last year were for premium-format theaters with bigger screens and better sound, compared with 13% in 2021. They cost an average of \$18 nationally, according to research firm EntTelligence, and as much as \$30 in big cities such as New York and Los Angeles.

Welcome to the new box office reality. Die-hards are paying top dollar while the rest of the country rarely goes to the theater and gets most of their entertainment from Netflix, YouTube and TikTok. Despite recent hits such as "Michael," "Project Hail Mary" and "The Super Mario Galaxy Movie," the annual number of tickets sold is down more than one-third from before the pandemic.

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Suspect Accused Of Trying To Kill President

Alleged gunman at Washington gala also charged with two firearms offenses

WASHINGTON—The man accused of opening fire outside a Washington press gala over the weekend was charged on Monday with attempting to assassinate President Trump, as officials defended the security at the high-profile dinner but promised to re-evaluate protocols for future events.

By Sadie Gurman,
C. Ryan Barber
and Alyssa Lukpat

Cole Allen, 31 years old, was also charged with two firearms offenses after officials said he charged past a security perimeter and opened fire at the Washington Hilton, the site of the annual White House Correspondents' Association dinner. Allen faces a potential life sentence on the attempted assassination charge alone.

During a 15-minute court hearing Monday, Magistrate Judge Matthew Sharbaugh said Allen faced a mandatory minimum sentence of 10 years on a charge of discharging a firearm during a crime of violence, and up to a decade on the separate firearms offense.

Appearing in a blue jumpsuit Monday, Allen gave brief responses—"I do," "yes, your honor"—to routine questions during his initial court appearance. Asked his highest

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- ◆ **Antigovernment violence reaches 30-year high.....** A4
- ◆ **Trump pushes ballroom after press dinner attack.....** A5